Figurative Language (Set B)

Year 4 Pt 2 · **Mark Scheme**

Lesson Worksheet — Answers

Core Practice

1. Personification (the wind is given the human/animal action of 'howling')
2. Simile (uses 'like' to compare her eyes to diamonds)
3. Alliteration (repeated 'b' sound in 'Busy bees buzzed by the blossoms')
4. Onomatopoeia ('sizzled' imitates the sound)
5. B) simile
6. B) metaphor
7. Personification (leaves are given the human action of 'dancing')
8. C) To do or say something to relieve tension or start a conversation
9. 'pop'
10. A) "She runs like the wind." and C) "He is as cunning as a fox."
11. Alliteration (repeated 's' sound)
12. to accidentally reveal a secret
13. Metaphor (the storm IS described as a monster, with no 'like'/'as')
14. B) onomatopoeia
15. Personification (the moon is given the human action of 'winking')

Applied Practice

16. It suggests the classroom was completely, almost eerily quiet — comparing the silence to the stillness of a graveyard.
17. It suggests his words were sharp and deeply hurtful, as if they physically wounded the listener.
18. Simile ('like an angry giant') and personification (thunder 'grumbled', a human-like sound/action).
19. It means it is now someone else's turn or responsibility to take the next action or decision.
20. B) alliteration
21. B) He took on more responsibilities than he could manage
22. Personification (floorboards given the human action/sound of 'groaning')
23. e.g. "He moved as slowly as a snail crossing a garden."
24. e.g. "The classroom was a zoo."
25. A) "The wind whispered secrets through the trees.", C) "The old house groaned and creaked." and E) "The flowers nodded in the breeze."
26. It means something that happens very rarely.
27. It is a metaphor because the snow is described AS a blanket directly, without using 'like' or 'as'.
28. Onomatopoeia ('Crash! Bang!' imitate the sounds)
29. A) butterflies
30. C) The news shocked and overwhelmed her suddenly

Challenge

31. It works well because a rollercoaster has unpredictable ups, downs and sudden turns, just like life's good times, hard times and unexpected events — the comparison captures both the excitement and the loss of control we feel about the future.
32. A) Alliteration and C) Personification

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33. A simile compares two things using 'like' or 'as' (e.g. "The snow fell like confetti"); a metaphor states that one thing IS another, without 'like'/'as' (e.g. "The snow was a white carpet").
34. B) To make non-human things feel alive, relatable or emotionally significant
35. It means that what people do matters more than what they say or promise; e.g. it might be used after someone who talks about helping others finally proves it through a real act of kindness.
36. Personification (the screen is given the human action of 'staring')
37. e.g. "keep it under your hat" and "button your lip" (also accept "hold your tongue")
38. Personification ("never sleeps") combined with simile ("like a thousand restless eyes") — together they make the city feel like a living, watchful being that is always awake.
39. B) take the bull by the horns
40. It is figurative/hyperbolic — the silence is so complete and unsettling that it feels as overwhelming as a loud noise, even though silence itself makes no sound.
41. Personification (opportunity is given the human action of 'knocking')
42. A) "The old oak tree stretched its branches like weary arms.", C) "The wind howled like a wolf through the abandoned house." and E) "The river roared like a lion as it surged through the gorge."
43. e.g. "The exam was a mountain looming ahead of me. Each revision session was another step up its steep slopes, and when I finally finished the last question, I felt as though I had reached the summit."
44. D) "He was on cloud nine after failing his driving test." ('on cloud nine' means extremely happy, which doesn't fit failing a test)
45. The repeated 'p' sound creates a playful, tongue-twisting rhythm that makes the line fun and memorable to say, and draws extra attention to the key words.

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Homework Worksheet — Answers

Core Practice

1. Simile ('like feathers')
2. Onomatopoeia ('clattered and clanged' imitate the sounds)
3. Alliteration (repeated 's' sound)
4. Personification (the sun is given the human action of 'smiling')
5. B) metaphor
6. B) simile
7. B) Something very easy to do
8. Personification (leaves given the human action of 'whispering')
9. 'bang'
10. A) "He is a shining star on the team.", C) "The classroom was a zoo during the party." and E) "Time is a thief, stealing moments away."
11. Alliteration (repeated 'b' sound)
12. feeling slightly unwell
13. Metaphor (her heart IS described as a block of ice)
14. B) onomatopoeia
15. Personification (the car given human actions 'grumbled and groaned')

Applied Practice

16. It suggests the playground was extremely noisy, disorganised and hectic, comparing it to the frenzy of feeding time at a zoo.
17. It suggests her determination was powerful, constant and unstoppable, like a fire that keeps burning.
18. Simile ('like thunder') and personification (waves 'roared', a human/animal-like sound given to the waves).
19. It means someone is being unrealistic or not paying attention to practical matters; daydreaming.
20. C) onomatopoeia
21. B) The final small event that causes someone to lose patience after a series of problems
22. Personification (the wind given the human/animal action of 'biting')
23. e.g. "The playground was as hot as an oven."
24. e.g. "He was a zombie by the end of the school day."
25. A) "The fog crept silently over the hills.", C) "The machine groaned under the strain." and E) "The curtains danced in the gentle breeze."
26. it means something is very expensive
27. It is a metaphor because the classroom IS described as a beehive directly, without using 'like' or 'as'.
28. Onomatopoeia ('Tick-tock' imitates the sound of the clock)
29. A) walk in the park
30. C) Her words deeply hurt his feelings

Standard / Advanced

31. Personification — the boat is given human actions ('battled') and the waves are given the human-like action of 'roaring' (the alliteration is 'brave...battled bravely').
32. It means to make a bad situation worse, often by criticising or mocking someone who is already hurt or struggling. It is a kind of hyperbole because it exaggerates the idea of adding a further, extreme form of harm ('injury') on top of an insult, when usually no real physical injury has occurred.

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33. Personification (the fire is given human body parts — 'fingers' — and the human action of 'creeping'); 'metaphor' for the word 'fingers' alone is also acceptable.
34. "The children were a thunderstorm."
35. It means to achieve two goals with a single action. Someone unfamiliar with idioms might take it literally and think the sentence describes actually harming birds, rather than understanding it describes being efficient by combining two errands.
36. Personification ('the house sighed'), simile ('like chattering teeth'), and onomatopoeia ('clattered').
37. A) up to your eyes, B) have your hands full and D) run off your feet
38. e.g. "The buzzing bees droned on" — 'buzzing' and 'droned' are onomatopoeia (sound words), while the repeated 'b' in 'buzzing bees' is alliteration (repeated sound at the start of words); the devices can overlap in the same sentence but describe different things.
39. B) "The moon watched over the sleeping village."
40. e.g. "Her mind was a cluttered attic, crammed with half-finished thoughts. Every time she tried to find one idea, three more tumbled down on top of it."
41. B
42. A) "After the long journey, we were all dead on our feet.", C) "She felt like a fish out of water at the fancy dinner, since she didn't know anyone." and E) "They decided to bite the bullet and finally tell their parents the truth."
43. Combining the two devices lets the writer create a single, more vivid and emotionally rich image — the simile sets up a clear comparison while the personification makes the non-human object feel alive and purposeful, deepening the reader's engagement.
44. B) cool as a cucumber
45. Simile: "like a hamster on a wheel" — it reveals that Tom's thoughts feel frantic, repetitive and unproductive, mirroring the anxious, exhausting feeling of running without getting anywhere.

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